

r/climatechange

Would a ban on AI do anything meaningful to save the environment or would it be not enough

Posted by u/Beautiful_Strike5217 • • 0 points • 2 comments

Personally I support banning some forms of AI but I think a more realistic option is just to put heavy regulation.

Comments

u/Economy-Fee5830 • 2 points • 2026-01-03 11:51 UTC

Apparently in 2025 AI data centres used about ****100**** TWH of electricity.

We generated about ****31,000**** TWH of electricity in 2025.

AI is misdirection.

u/sg_plumber • 1 points • 2026-01-03 11:42 UTC

If you mean for their energy usage, or the energy usage of datacenters, it's been greatly exaggerated by everyone, and easy enough to supply with greentech.

If you mean for datacenter water usage or heat waste, there's plenty workarounds for both.

OTOH, AI tools are being used to speedup scientific and engineering R&D, and we need those.